Appeasement thus offers IOs a pragmatic way to address some populist challenges. By carefully calibrating concessions, IOs can maintain their operations while minimizing damage to their core missions. However, this strategy requires precision, transparency, and foresight to avoid empowering populists or compromising institutional integrity.

2.3.2 Sidelining Populists

In the face of populist resistance, IOs may find their best course of action is working around rather than directly confronting populist leaders. By reducing interactions with populists and thereby minimizing their influence, IOs can create a buffer, allowing operations to continue with less interference. Interestingly, populists may also welcome a reduced role, avoiding the scrutiny or commitments that come with active participation. This mutual disengagement enables IOs to maintain formal ties with populist-led states, keeping the door open for renewed collaboration if leadership changes.

Sidelining can range from overt measures, like imposing sanctions or suspending memberships to more subtle tactics, such as limiting invitations to key meetings or withholding communication. Sanctions and suspensions are not new; they are often shaped by geopolitical considerations, such as the intransigent countries' closeness to powerful stakeholders (von Borzyskowski and Vabulas 2019a). These actions aim to bring populists back into compliance, deter other states from undertaking similar behavior, or garner support from nonpopulist allies, NGOs, or domestic constituencies.

On a subtler level, IOs can isolate populists by engaging only selectively with them. This mirrors domestic strategies where nonpopulist political parties marginalize populists by excluding them from coalitions or alliances (Akkerman and Rooduijn 2015). Such approaches can also complement appeasement strategies, offering populists benefits for cooperation while exacting costs for defiance.

IOs can sideline populists in several specific ways. First, they can strengthen their internal capabilities. This might include investing in new surveillance technologies, expanding on-the-ground inspections, or refining open-source intelligence analysis. Hiring additional experts or retraining